



netbook form factor space. That might change with Intel's Haswell chips where the onboard Intel HD 4000 series GPU's supposed to run faster than Usain Bolt, we can't say for sure, not having tested any of the Intel Haswell machines yet. As far as external GPUs are concerned, NVIDIA's GeForce 700M and AMD's Radeon HD 8000M series of mobile GPUs have already made their way onto laptops and ultrabooks last month. Not having benchmarked any of these new mobile GPUs firsthand, we can't really comment on their performance, but NVIDIA's GeForce 780M seems to be stealing a march on the AMD Radeon HD 8970M graphics. However, you should only worry about such discrete GPUs if you desire to play the latest games at unrestricted settings on your laptop or ultrabook.

Displays are improving in terms of screen resolutions on laptops and ultrabooks, in recent years -- and rightly so, which self-respecting laptop will see its larger screen size pack in lesser pixels than a 5-inch smartphone's? Products like the retina display Apple MacBook Pro, Toshiba KiraBook and Google Chromebook Pixel have led the way in recent months and are forcing laptop manufacturers to up the ante as far as higher-resolution displays are concerned. The norm for 11 to 15-inch laptops is still stuck at 1366x768 resolution, but as we said the number of mid-ranged laptops supporting 1600x900 or Full HD 1920x1080 pixel resolution is slowly and surely on the rise.